# Chet Aldrich

Software Engineer

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## Summary

Engineering leader who has personally driven tens of millions of dollars in incremental revenue and millions in annual profit impact across insurance, e-commerce, and on-demand delivery. Promoted through multiple engineering roles to Principal Software Engineer at Root Insurance by combining technical strategy, cross-functional influence, and product sense to ship real, useful software to millions of customers. Most recent work focuses on AI enablement: a shared, governed way for teams to access models and measure whether AI features work, plus company-wide adoption of AI coding assistants and agents.

## Work Experience

### Root Insurance

*Remote*

Principal Software Engineer — *Oct 2026 - Present*

- Set technical direction for AI adoption across the company, defining how engineering and business teams adopt and evaluate models and agents in production.
- Rolled out Langfuse to production as a shared foundation for AI evaluation, giving teams traces of model and tool behavior for debugging plus evaluation workflows to compare results across representative cases.

Senior Staff Software Engineer — *Mar 2024 - Oct 2026*

- Tapped by the CTO to lead technical delivery for a strategic partnership with Hyundai, now the Secure+ program in Arizona. It generates roughly $450k a month in premium revenue, with expansion planned.
- Orchestrated PCI 4.0.1 compliance including change management (6.4.3) and file integrity monitoring (11.6.1), and provided guidance and auditor walkthroughs for Sarbanes-Oxley compliance.
- Identified and mitigated multiple critical security incidents as the direct point of contact for responsible disclosure, producing proofs of concept, deploying emergency patches, and coordinating external audits.
- Made the case for and led the split of billing from policy management, completing the transition to three dedicated teams (legal document generation, policy management, and billing). Partnered with my manager to interview and onboard new engineers.
- Redeveloped Root's interview process and leveling guide for individual contributor hiring, stewarding a process that doubled headcount with consistently strong candidate feedback.
- Scaled Bifrost from an engineering pilot to the company's shared AI gateway in 2026. Expanded it from a single OpenAI contract to Anthropic, Gemini, and open-weight models available across the business. Owned procurement, provider setup, and access configuration for Gemini and Fireworks, and supported the Anthropic integration.
- Drove company-wide adoption of AI coding tools: piloting GitHub Copilot through procurement and infosec in 2024, running OpenAI Codex roadshows in 2025, and enabling teams on OpenCode with gateway-backed models and MCP tooling in 2026.

Staff Software Engineer — *Nov 2022 - Mar 2024*

- Designed and led development, with two other engineering teams, of a system that lets the business configure fee revenue by market. It generates an incremental $31 million a year in revenue not subject to premium taxation or reinsurance cost.
- Led development of GUARD-EB, a machine learning model that adjusts customer down payments. It produced a 0.5% loss ratio impact ($4.5M annual profit) and gave Data Science a significant lever for managing new writings growth.
- Consolidated billing from policy-term-level to account-level to enable early renewal payments, driving an estimated 0.68% net retention uplift across the book of business.
- Steered the team through two quarters without a manager, owning quarterly planning, prioritization, and cross-functional coordination to keep business-critical initiatives on track.

Senior Software Engineer — *Oct 2021 - Nov 2022*

- Designed, built, and deployed a customer profile storage system. It cut read load on the monolith's primary database by about 20% and enabled new use cases, including automated underwriting decisions and pricing analysis.
- Moved the company's monitoring and alerting infrastructure from Grafana to Datadog, saving the company about $100k a year.

### Amazon

*Remote*

Software Development Engineer

*Apr. 2020 - Aug. 2021*

- Led a project extending the seller support application to vendors, deprecating a redundant system. Also internationalized the app for eight new countries, including some with RTL and logographic languages.
- Partnered with Product to define the international seller support experience, leading a program that globalized Seller Central's customer support across three projects covering issue discovery, help content search, and case creation and transfer.

### Postmates

*Remote*

Senior Software Engineer

*Sep 2019 - Apr 2020*

- Built and released an inventory management system for the Postmates integration with Google Search, Maps, and the Assistant. Owned its ongoing development as it grew to generate an incremental $72 million in yearly revenue.
- Led my team's migration from AWS to GCP, establishing IAM policies and Terraform patterns adopted by the Buyer team.
- Built common libraries to simplify data processing and I/O in Apache Beam, adopted by four teams across the company.

Software Engineer II

*Feb 2018 - Sep 2019*

- Expanded the search API to include local product search, product search within menus/catalogs, and search suggestions, coordinating with client engineers from three platforms (Android, iOS, Web) to consume the new API.
- As a core contributor to the Postmates feed data pipeline, drove optimizations that increased deliveries 1.5%, first-time jobs 2%, and cut average drop-off distance across all deliveries.
- Built the initial infrastructure for classifying customers, which became the basis for personalization of the app experience.
- Built tooling that simplified creating new search indices. It powered a customer support search service and a place-matching service that replaced a Foursquare-based ingestion system with a data pipeline for new locations.

Software Engineer

*Sep 2017 - Feb 2018*

- Rebuilt search from the ground up, moving from a third-party solution to a solution with incremental search for restaurants and an adjustable internal ranking algorithm.

### Pandora

*Oakland, CA*

Software Engineer

*Aug. 2016 - Aug. 2017*

- Built a MapReduce pipeline to estimate reach and frequency for ad campaigns which decreased forecast runtime by 37 percent.
- Built automated reporting jobs to identify trending artist messages and featured tracks for the Music Makers team.
- Created tools to help artists identify regional variations in popularity of their songs.

## Education

### Carleton College

*Northfield, MN*

B.A. Computer Science

*Sep. 2012 - Jun. 2016*

- Rewarded distinction in the major for outstanding work in the senior integrative exercise.

## Skills

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| **Languages** | Python, Ruby, Scala, Java, Go, Rust |
| **Frameworks** | Ruby on Rails, Apache Beam |
| **AI Tools** | Bifrost, Langfuse, OpenAI Codex, OpenCode |
| **Deployment Platforms** | AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes |
| **Databases** | Postgres, DynamoDB, Bigtable/HBase |
| **Tools** | Git, Docker, Terraform, Datadog, Vim, LaTeX |